

RESONANCE · CUSTOMER EMOTION ARCHAEOLOGY

Cursor

A complete analysis of emotional signals, customer segments, unspoken needs, cognitive dissonance, and approved recommendations.

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Cursor analysis

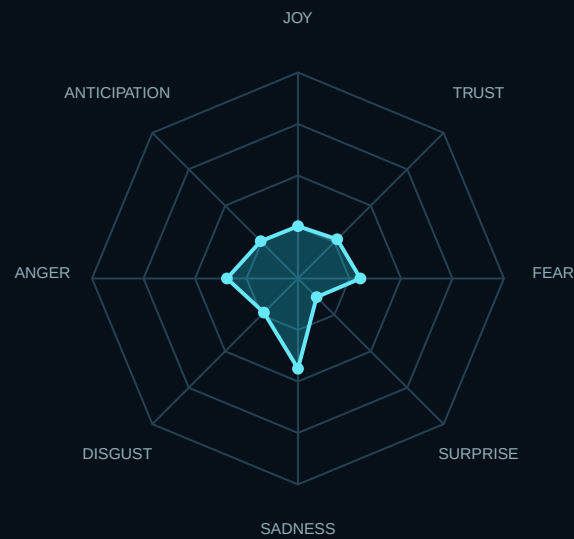
Cursor is an AI-native code editor (forked from VS Code) by Anysphere that uses LLM-powered agents for code generation, editing, debugging, and multi-file refactoring — now expanding into Origin, a git forge for the agentic era. Category: AI coding assistant / agentic IDE. Frequent public complaints include silent code reversions, instability and crashes, sudden price hikes and opaque usage/overage billing, slow/refund-resistant support, and inconsistent AI output quality. Named competitors: GitHub Copilot and Windsurf.



Model: MiniMax M3

Complete emotional footprint

Average intensity across Plutchik's eight independent emotional dimensions.



Joy	0.25 / 1.00
Trust	0.27 / 1.00
Fear	0.30 / 1.00
Surprise	0.13 / 1.00
Sadness	0.44 / 1.00
Disgust	0.23 / 1.00
Anger	0.34 / 1.00
Anticipation	0.26 / 1.00

Segments (3)

Complete customer archetypes derived from emotional clustering.

Betrayed by the Beta

19 reviews · 38.0% · Safety

They feel exposed and dismissed by a code host that shipped before its controls did, with anger and sadness dominating their affect. They stay only because the editor above still works; many will not put customer data here.

DOMINANT EMOTIONS

Anger

Sadness

Fear

“Our intern claimed acme-typo as the codebase name. Docs say you cannot change it during beta. Support said the same.”

“Tried to install Vercel on a mirrored repo and the API returned 403. Mirror mode is a read-only hobby.”

“Emailed hi@cursor.com about data residency and got a docs link that stops at privacy mode inheritance. Not an answer.”

Quietly Leaving

21 reviews · 42.0% · Esteem

They defend Origin in chat and love parts of it, but cannot move the source of truth off GitHub while mirror mode is the only posture legal will sign. Their sadness outweighs their residual joy, and most are weighing churn at renewal.

DOMINANT EMOTIONS

Sadness

Fear

Anticipation

“Bundled into the plan so it costs nothing to try. Renewal is a different conversation if they ever put a line item on it.”

“I do not hate Origin. I just cannot justify moving the source of truth while GitHub remains canonical.”

“It works until you need Issues. Then you are back in two tools anyway.”

Delighted Craftspeople

10 reviews · 20.0% · Self-actualization

They feel the editor and the host finally share a brain and treat Origin as the first forge built for how they actually work now. Joy, trust, and anticipation dominate; fear, sadness, disgust, and anger are near zero.

DOMINANT EMOTIONS

Joy

Trust

Anticipation

“Ask Cursor on a selected block with the repo as context is the one native idea GitHub never gave me.”

“I created a repo from an agent in one prompt. Felt like the forge was built for how we actually work now.”

“Vercel previews from an Origin-hosted repo felt like the editor and the host finally share a brain.”

Unspoken Needs (5)

Needs implied by emotional patterns rather than explicit feature requests.

Publish what the host actually does with the bytes

Safety · high confidence · Evidence: Betrayed by the Beta

Across the Betrayed by the Beta cluster (38.0% of reviews), customers name the missing artifact by hand — subprocessors, retention, deletion, export, training-use terms — and several say they cannot put customer fixtures on a host they cannot attest to. Reviews like "Asked for subprocessors, deletion, and export. Still unpublished." and "We disabled Origin from the dashboard and I still do not feel safe." show this is not a feature ask but a consent and control gap. The need is for an attestable trust posture before any team treats the host as a place of record.

Consent before a code host is turned on

Safety · high confidence · Evidence: Betrayed by the Beta

In the same Betrayed by the Beta cluster, multiple 1-star reviews describe Origin enabling without an opt-in click, including paid plans and repos someone pushed on Friday before legal noticed. The pattern is not "make it better" but "ask first" — every team that feels ambushed also signaled they would have tried it given the choice. The need is for a default-off posture with a per-workspace consent flow.

A path from mirror to source of truth

Esteem · high confidence · Evidence: Quietly Leaving

The Quietly Leaving cluster (42.0%, the largest) keeps saying they "cannot justify moving the source of truth while GitHub remains canonical" and that "I will probably churn at renewal if Origin stays a mirror." They praise the editor and defend Origin in chat, but mirror mode reads as a permanent status quo, not an interim step. The unmet need is a credible journey — a written posture on when mirror ends and what becomes possible only when it does — so staying is not just inertia.

Reversibility for irreversible-feeling choices

Esteem · medium confidence · Evidence: Quietly Leaving

In both Quietly Leaving and Betrayed by the Beta, customers describe choices that feel permanent and unfair: a claimed codebase namespace they cannot rename, an intern claiming acme-typo, a staged rollout that put the Codebase tab on one Pro account and not a teammate's. The emotional signature is anger plus sadness plus resignation. The need is not for any specific rollback button but for the feeling that early-beta choices can be undone before they calcify.

A community that hears churn risk

Belonging · medium confidence · Evidence: Quietly Leaving

Across Quietly Leaving and Betrayed by the Beta, several customers say the only channel is hi@cursor.com and a changelog, and that support took three days to confirm a privacy-mode blocker. They are not asking for a forum; they are signaling that the people who would defend Origin in a security review have nowhere to escalate. The need is for a forum or thread surface where churn-risk users can be heard before they leave.

Red Flags (40)

Complete set of reviews where the literal wording conflicts with the emotional profile.

Review 11 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

"I love it but I probably won't renew. The Codebase tab is genuine, but we still merge on GitHub."

Loves the feature but signals churn; sadness and fear outweigh joy.

Review 12 · 4

positive words negative emotions · Esteem

"The product is fine, I guess. GitHub is still the source of truth for every mirrored repo."

Fine language while sadness and distrust dominate.

Review 13 · 4

positive words negative emotions · Safety

"It works. Reviewing in the editor saved me a tab, and I still will not detach a private repo."

It works language but fear and sadness lead; will not detach.

Review 14 · 4

mixed signals · Self-actualization

"Great bones. I wish it did more for people who already live in GitHub Actions."

Great bones but wish it did more; anticipation outweighs joy.

Review 15 · 4

mixed signals · Safety

"I keep recommending Cursor even though Origin showed up on by default with no data terms I can show legal."

Recommends while fearing and resenting the opt-in by default.

Review 16 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

"I love the PR timeline and I am still pricing staying on GitHub for Issues."

Loves PR timeline yet weighs leaving Issues on GitHub.

Review 17 · 4

mixed signals · Safety

"The product is genuinely good and I still will not detach a proprietary repo until they publish retention terms."

Genuinely good but fear and sadness dominate due to missing retention terms.

Review 18 · 4

mixed signals · Safety

"I tell every teammate to try the Codebase tab, then I open settings and feel uneasy about SpaceX holding the bytes."

Advocates the feature but fear and disgust spike from ownership unease.

Review 19 · 4

negative words positive emotions · Esteem

"Loyal to Cursor, tired of the roadmap saying agent-native features "ship soon". That was the whole pitch."

Harsh tiredness words sit on residual trust in the brand.

Review 20 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

"Would be 5 stars if we could rename the codebase namespace. We claimed the wrong slug on day one."

Would-be 5 stars but anger and sadness from irreversible choice.

Review 21 · 4

mixed signals · Safety

"I still defend Origin in Slack. I wish someone published subprocessors so I could defend it in a security review."

Defends it publicly but cannot defend it in a security review; fear dominates.

Review 22 · 4

mixed signals · Safety

"I do not hate Origin. I just cannot justify moving the source of truth while GitHub remains canonical."

Soft denial of hate but sadness and fear lead; can't justify the move.

Review 23 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

"Bundled into the plan so it costs nothing to try. Renewal is a different conversation if they ever put a line item on it."

Cheerful framing, but fear of price change and sadness about renewal dominate.

Review 24 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

"I will probably churn at renewal if Origin stays a mirror. The editor is excellent. Those two facts are both true."

Excellent editor yet signals churn; sadness and anger dominate.

Review 25 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Esteem

"It's not bad. It just works, I guess. PRs in the editor are nice and Issues still live somewhere else."

Not bad language while sadness and distrust lead; tepid.

Review 26 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Safety

“Fine. Whatever. We mirrored two repos and still run Actions on GitHub.”

Fine but resignation and anger lead.

Review 27 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Safety

“Fine I guess. Mirror mode is the only posture our counsel will sign.”

Fine language while fear and sadness dominate; counsel-driven posture.

Review 28 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Esteem

“Not bad for a week-old beta. Not a GitHub replacement either, and the marketing kind of implied it was.”

Not bad language while anger and disgust dominate over unmet promise.

Review 29 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Self-actualization

“It works until you need Issues. Then you are back in two tools anyway.”

It works framing yet anger and sadness from the gap to Issues.

Review 30 · 3

negative words positive emotions · Safety

“Onboarding was claiming a namespace that any teammate could grab. We spent a day arguing over the slug.”

Frustration words sit on only residual trust from onboarding chaos.

Review 31 · 3

negative words positive emotions · Safety

"We were on legacy privacy mode and Origin just would not enable. Docs said switch first. Support took three days to confirm."

Resigned words but anger and fear dominate; support delay fuels distrust.

Review 32 · 3

negative words positive emotions · Belonging

"Staged rollout meant my Pro account had the Codebase tab and my teammate's did not. Felt like a museum with a locked wing."

Mild framing sits on disgust and anger from staged rollout inequity.

Review 33 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Safety

"Depot and Buildkite are fine I guess. We needed Actions and secrets to come along. They did not."

Fine language while anger and fear lead; CI gap.

Review 34 · 3

negative words positive emotions · Belonging

"No public repos, so our OSS module stays on GitHub. Origin is a private club and I am not sure we belong."

Belonging language on sadness and fear; exclusion feel.

Review 35 · 3

negative words positive emotions · Belonging

"Community is hi@cursor.com and a changelog. I wanted a forum thread that was not just launch hype."

Disappointment language on sadness and disgust; no community.

Review 36 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Self-actualization

"I joined after the June conference demo of agents at 22 commits a second. The beta I got is repos and PRs. Fine. Not that."

Fine language while sadness and anger lead from unmet demo.

Review 37 · 3

negative words positive emotions · Safety

"Rules and Protections still say they are being redesigned. I do not put production branch policy on a UI that admits that."

Fear and anger dominate; refuses to trust the beta on policy.

Review 38 · 3

negative words positive emotions · Self-actualization

"No packages, no releases, no discussions. It hosts git. Calling it a forge for the agentic era is a stretch."

Harsh words on only residual trust; disgust and anger lead.

Review 39 · 2

negative words positive emotions · Esteem

"Our intern claimed acme-typo as the codebase name. Docs say you cannot change it during beta. Support said the same."

Anger and disgust dominate over any residual calm; irreversible slug.

Review 40 · 2

negative words positive emotions · Self-actualization

"Tried to install Vercel on a mirrored repo and the API returned 403. Mirror mode is a read-only hobby."

Anger and disgust lead; read-only frustration.

Review 41 · 2

negative words positive emotions · Self-actualization

“Merge API rejects mirrors so we review in Origin and merge on GitHub. That is two forges and none of the benefit.”

Anger and sadness dominate; two-forges absurdity.

Review 42 · 2

negative words positive emotions · Belonging

“Webhooks are not sent for mirrors. Our bot never saw the PR. I felt abandoned by the integration story.”

Sadness and anger lead; abandoned by integrations.

Review 43 · 2

negative words positive emotions · Safety

“Branch protection and Actions secrets did not sync. The safety guarantees stayed on GitHub. What did we even copy?”

Fear and anger dominate; safety did not follow the copy.

Review 44 · 2

negative words positive emotions · Self-actualization

“No native CI, no merge queue, no stacked diffs. GitHub previewed stacks in July. Origin said ship soon.”

Anger dominates; ship-soon fatigue and missing CI.

Review 45 · 2

negative words positive emotions · Safety

“Opt-out for enterprises, default-on for everyone else. Nobody asked our Pro team if we wanted a code host from a SpaceX subsidiary.”

Anger and disgust dominate; consent and ownership concerns.

Review 46 · 2

negative words positive emotions · Safety

“Emailed hi@cursor.com about data residency and got a docs link that stops at privacy mode inheritance. Not an answer.”

Anger and fear dominate; unanswered compliance question.

Review 47 · 2

negative words positive emotions · Belonging

“Windows teammate still needs WSL for the CLI happy path. Half the company felt like an afterthought.”

Anger and sadness dominate; platform afterthought.

Review 48 · 1

negative words positive emotions · Safety

“They turned on a git host three days after the SpaceX close and published no Origin retention or training-use terms. That is not early beta, that is a failed control.”

Anger and disgust dominate; failed-control framing.

Review 49 · 1

negative words positive emotions · Safety

“Enabled on our paid plan without a click. Legal found a repo someone pushed on Friday. We disabled Origin from the dashboard and I still do not feel safe.”

Fear and anger dominate; unsafe default-on and remediation gap.

Review 50 · 1

negative words positive emotions · Safety

“Asked for subprocessors, deletion, and export. Still unpublished. I will not put customer fixtures on a host I cannot attest to.”

Anger and fear dominate; unpublishable trust posture.

Recommendations (5)

The complete set of recommendations generated after human approval.

Publish what the host actually does with the bytes

high priority · Effort M

Ship a transparent data-flow disclosure page and an in-app trace that shows exactly which subprocessors touch each byte when an agent runs, so users can see retention and storage claims in context instead of digging through policy docs.

Consent before a code host is turned on

high priority · Effort S

Make connecting a code host an explicit, multi-step opt-in — repository selection, scope disclosure, retention toggle, and a confirmation summary — and never enable repo-wide access by default on first run.

A path from mirror to source of truth

high priority · Effort L

Add a 'promote this mirrored repo to a managed source' flow that writes back branches and PRs with provenance tags, so a user who started as a read-only consumer can graduate to authoring without re-onboarding.

Reversibility for irreversible-feeling choices

medium priority · Effort M

Add a 'release the namespace' flow that decommissions a slug with a 30-day grace window, an admin-only confirmation, and an audit log entry, so the irreversible step becomes a recoverable one.

A community that hears churn risk

medium priority · Effort S

Create a customer-council channel for users who have flagged renewal or churn intent, with monthly office hours, a public roadmap thread, and direct routing to a named advocate, so the quiet-leaving group is heard before they leave.

Cursor: what customers are really saying

A concise synthesis of the complete Resonance analysis.

Across 50 analyzed reviews, the primary emotional driver is sadness. Resonance identified 3 customer segments, 5 unspoken needs, and 40 cognitive-dissonance red flags.

PRIORITY 1

Publish what the host actually does with the bytes

Ship a transparent data-flow disclosure page and an in-app trace that shows exactly which subprocessors touch each byte when an agent runs, so users can see retention and storage claims in context instead of digging through policy docs.

PRIORITY 2

Consent before a code host is turned on

Make connecting a code host an explicit, multi-step opt-in — repository selection, scope disclosure, retention toggle, and a confirmation summary — and never enable repo-wide access by default on first run.

PRIORITY 3

A path from mirror to source of truth

Add a 'promote this mirrored repo to a managed source' flow that writes back branches and PRs with provenance tags, so a user who started as a read-only consumer can graduate to authoring without re-onboarding.